



Calm Home Skills

Premium practice worksheet

CALM HOME SKILLS - LESSON 03

Address the reason first, not just the noise.

Use this worksheet to track barking triggers, reduce unnecessary rehearsal, and reinforce alternate behaviors that are easier to live with at home.

TRAINER NOTE

Barking is information. When you understand the trigger, you can build a plan instead of reacting to the symptom.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner can identify the dog's main barking triggers, adjust the setup, and reinforce quieter, more useful responses.

2 Practice plan

1

Track the trigger

Write down what happened right before the barking started.

2

Manage the setup

Lower visibility, distance, or intensity so your dog rehearses less barking.

3

Reward the alternate behavior

Mark quiet check-ins, turning away, or moving to the mat.

4

Practice easy versions

Train around mild versions of the trigger before expecting success in harder moments.



Calm Home Skills

Barking Basics

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Treats ready in key areas
- ☐ Window film, baby gate, or management tools if needed
- ☐ Notebook or phone log
- ☐ White noise or calming background sound if helpful

Set up before you start

- ☐ List the top three barking triggers at home.
- ☐ Reduce access to the hardest trigger while you are training.
- ☐ Choose one replacement behavior to reinforce, such as orienting to you or

4 Barking trigger tracker

Date	Trigger	Setup	Dog response	What worked	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



Calm Home Skills

Barking Basics

6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Waiting until the barking is intense before intervening.
- Relying on scolding instead of changing the setup.
- Expecting the dog to ignore a trigger they have not practiced around.
- Leaving windows, doors, or routines unchanged while training.

If this happens, try this

- If barking is sudden and intense, begin by managing the environment more aggressively.
- If the dog quiets briefly then restarts, reward earlier and move farther from the trigger.
- If you are unsure of the function, keep a simple log for a week and look for patterns.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can name my dog's top barking triggers.
- ☐ I have at least one management change in place.
- ☐ I know what alternate behavior I am rewarding.
- ☐ I am tracking what helps reduce barking episodes.

HOMEWORK

Track one barking trigger for five days. Note the trigger, your setup, how quickly your dog recovered, and what alternate behavior you reinforced.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____